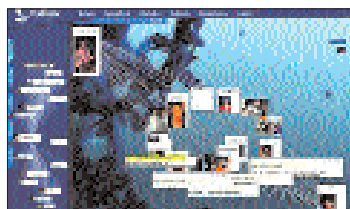


Microsoft to sparkle and wallop

Microsoft is developing an animation toolset—code-named Sparkle—as a part of Longhorn, the next version of Windows. Sparkle has already been put to use—the clock in the side bar of Longhorn was developed using Sparkle. This tool, which is expected to be released before Longhorn is shipped, is causing a lot of hype in an industry that sees it as a replace-

ment to the popular Flash, but Microsoft is quick to explain that Flash is a Web-based, platform independent tool, while Sparkle will just be a Windows application development tool.

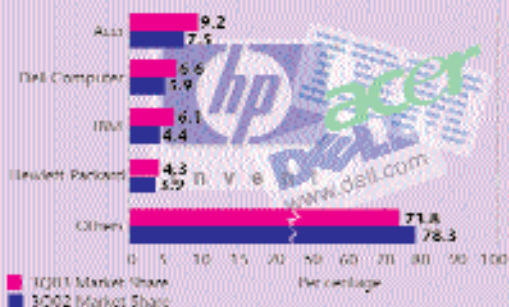
Social computing is another direction in which Microsoft is moving. The company announced that it is working on a tool called Wallop, which combines



blogging and social-networking capabilities. Although the tool was not made public, Microsoft did display some screenshots.

statattack

Asia-Pacific PC Unit Shipment Estimates of units for third quarter 2003



Source: Gartner

Estimates by country for third quarter 2003



Source: Gartner

INFOGRAPHICS: Sachin Davi

Virtual PC in production

Microsoft has announced the Release to Manufacturing (RTM) of its virtual machine solution—Virtual PC 2004—which will be available by the end of 2003. Using Virtual PC, multiple operating systems, including all Microsoft's operating systems, as well as OS/2, can be run on a single computer. One operating system is installed as the host, while the others are installed as guests.

Virtual PC is based on a technology from Connectix Corp., a company that's been into development of virtual machines since 1988. Microsoft has added support for four network adapters, XML file-based configuration, and support for memory up to 4 GB. It has retained earlier features of Connectix's

redalert

W32.Dumaru.a@MM

This mass-mailing worm arrives in an e-mail attachment as a .exe file. After infecting the host computer, it uses its own SMTP engine to e-mail itself to all contacts stored locally. It copies itself into the Windows folder, adds a few registry keys, and searches for .htm, .wab, .html, .dbx, .tbb, and .abd file extensions to spread the infection. Additionally, PWS-Narod—a password-logging program—is installed, which provides hackers an entry into the PC. Visit <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.dumaru@mm.removal.tool.html> for a removal tool.

W32.Mimail.i@MM

W32.Mimail.i@MM is a worm that steals credit card information by posing as an e-mail from an authorisation Web site called PayPal.com. The message indicates that your PayPal account will expire unless you run the attached applications and provide your credit card information. It then attempts to e-mail this information to four different e-mail addresses hard-coded into it. It also tries to connect to www.akamai.com and send the same information to pppinfo.sys—a group of e-mail addresses. Visit <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.mimail.removal.tool.html> for details on how to remove the worm.

■ Apple unveils the new iMac all-in-one desktop that comes with a 20-inch display ■ Microsoft starts testing MSN Newsbot—a personalised news search service

